[Resilience X]

Health and Insurance Benefits Guide 2024

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1.0 Introduction to Your Benefits

1.1 Our Commitment to Your Well-being

At [Resilience X], we believe that our employees are our greatest asset. Your health, and the health of your family, is of utmost importance. We are proud to offer a comprehensive and competitive benefits package designed to support your physical, mental, and financial well-being. This guide is your resource for understanding the valuable programs we provide to help you and your family live healthier, more secure lives. We encourage you to review this information carefully to make informed decisions and get the most out of your benefits.

1.2 Purpose of This Guide

This guide provides a detailed overview of the health and insurance benefits available to eligible employees for the 2024 plan year. It is intended to be a comprehensive resource to help you understand your options, enrollment procedures, coverage details, and the processes for using your benefits. Please note that this guide is a summary. For complete details, you must refer to the official plan documents and certificates of coverage, which are the governing legal documents. These are available on our benefits portal.

1.3 Understanding Key Insurance Terms

Navigating health insurance can be confusing. Here are some key terms to help you understand your coverage:

- **Premium:** The fixed amount you pay for your health insurance coverage, typically deducted from your paycheck on a pre-tax basis.
- **Deductible:** The amount you must pay out-of-pocket for covered health care services before your insurance plan starts to pay.
- **Co-payment (Co-pay):** A fixed amount you pay for a covered health care service after you've paid your deductible. For example, a $25 co-pay for a doctor's visit.
- **Co-insurance:** The percentage of costs of a covered health care service you pay after you've met your deductible. For example, if your co-insurance is 20%, you pay 20% of the cost of the service, and the insurance plan pays 80%.
- **Out-of-Pocket Maximum:** The most you have to pay for covered services in a plan year. After you spend this amount on deductibles, co-payments, and co-insurance, your health plan pays 100% of the costs of covered benefits.
- **In-Network:** Doctors, hospitals, and other health care providers who have contracted with your health insurance plan to provide services at discounted rates.
- **Out-of-Network:** Providers who do not have a contract with your health insurance plan. You will typically pay more for services from out-of-network providers.

- **Plan Year:** The 12-month period during which your benefit elections are effective. At [Resilience X], the plan year is January 1 to December 31.

2.0 Eligibility and Enrollment

2.1 Employee Eligibility

All regular, full-time U.S. employees scheduled to work 30 or more hours per week are eligible to enroll in the company's health and insurance benefit plans. Benefits for part-time employees are outlined in their specific employment agreements.

2.2 Dependent Eligibility

You may also enroll your eligible dependents in our medical, dental, and vision plans. "Is my spouse covered?" Yes, eligible dependents include:

- **Your legal spouse.**
- **Your registered domestic partner.**
- **Your children up to age 26,** regardless of marital, student, or financial dependency status. This includes your biological children, stepchildren, legally adopted children, and children for whom you are the legal guardian.
- **Your disabled children** of any age, if they were disabled before age 26 and are primarily dependent on you for support.

You will be required to provide documentation (e.g., marriage certificate, birth certificate) to verify dependent eligibility.

2.3 When You Can Enroll

There are three main opportunities to enroll in or make changes to your benefit elections.

2.3.1 New Hire Enrollment

As a new employee, you have **30 days** from your date of hire to enroll in benefits. Your coverage will be effective on the first day of the month following your hire date. If you do not enroll within this 30-day window, you will not have coverage and must wait until the next Annual Open Enrollment period, unless you experience a Qualifying Life Event.

2.3.2 Annual Open Enrollment

Open Enrollment is held once a year, typically in November. This is your annual opportunity to review your benefit options, make changes to your current coverage, and enroll for the upcoming plan year. The choices you make during Open Enrollment will be in effect for the entire next plan year (January 1 to December 31).

2.3.3 Qualifying Life Events (QLEs)

If you experience a significant life event, you may be able to make changes to your benefits outside of the Open Enrollment period. A QLE allows you to make changes that are consistent with the event. You have **30 days** from the date of the event to report it and make changes. Examples of QLEs include:

- Marriage or entering a domestic partnership

- Divorce or legal separation
- Birth or adoption of a child
- Death of a spouse or dependent
- Change in your or your spouse's employment status that affects benefits eligibility
- A dependent reaching age 26

2.4 How to Enroll

All benefit enrollments and changes are made through the company's online benefits portal, which can be accessed through the main HRIS dashboard. The portal provides detailed plan information, cost breakdowns, and decision support tools to help you choose the best plans for your needs.

2.5 Case Example: Enrolling After a Qualifying Life Event

- **Scenario:** Sarah, an employee, gives birth to her first child on May 10th. She is currently enrolled in employee-only medical coverage.
- **Action:**
    1. The birth of a child is a Qualifying Life Event. Sarah has 30 days from May 10th to make changes to her benefits.
    2. Within that window, Sarah logs into the benefits portal and reports the QLE.
    3. She uploads a copy of the hospital birth certificate to verify the event.
    4. She changes her medical plan coverage from "Employee Only" to "Employee + Children" and adds her new baby as a dependent. She also enrolls the baby in the dental and vision plans.
    5. The new coverage for her baby is effective retroactively to the date of birth, May 10th. The change in her premium contribution will be reflected in her next paycheck.

3.0 Medical Insurance Plans

3.1 Overview of Medical Plan Options

We offer two medical plan options through [National Insurance Carrier Name] to give you the flexibility to choose the coverage that best fits your needs and budget. Both plans provide comprehensive coverage for a wide range of medical services and include access to the same large, national network of doctors and hospitals.

1. **PPO (Preferred Provider Organization) Plan:** Offers lower deductibles and fixed co-pays for most services, but has higher monthly premiums.
2. **HDHP (High Deductible Health Plan) with HSA:** Features a lower monthly premium but a higher deductible that you must meet before the plan begins to pay. This plan is paired with a Health Savings Account (HSA) that allows you to save for medical expenses on a tax-free basis, including a generous company contribution.

3.2 Plan Comparison Table

Feature	PPO Plan	HDHP with HSA
Deductible (In-Network)	$1,000 Individual / $2,000 Family	$3,000 Individual / $6,000 Family
Out-of-Pocket Max (In-Network)	$4,000 Individual / $8,000 Family	$6,000 Individual / $12,000 Family
Primary Care Visit	$25 co-pay	You pay 100% until deductible is met, then 20% co-insurance
Specialist Visit	$50 co-pay	You pay 100% until deductible is met, then 20% co-insurance
Hospitalization (In-Network)	20% co-insurance after deductible	20% co-insurance after deductible
Preventive Care	Covered at 100% (deductible waived)	Covered at 100% (deductible waived)
Prescription Drugs	Tiered co-pays ($15/$40/$75)	You pay 100% until deductible is met, then tiered co-pays
Health Savings Account (HSA)	Not eligible	Eligible. **Company contributes $1,000/year for individuals and $2,000/year for families.**

3.3 Understanding How the Plans Work

3.3.1 PPO (Preferred Provider Organization) Plan

The PPO plan is a traditional health plan that offers predictability in costs. You have a fixed co-pay for most common services like doctor visits. This plan might be a good fit if you or your family members expect to use medical services frequently and you prefer to pay higher premiums for lower out-of-pocket costs at the time of service.

3.3.2 HDHP (High Deductible Health Plan) with HSA

The HDHP offers a trade-off: you pay lower monthly premiums in exchange for a higher deductible. This means you are responsible for 100% of your medical and prescription costs until your deductible is met (preventive care is an exception and is always covered at 100%). This plan is powerful when combined with the Health Savings Account (HSA). The company makes a significant contribution to your HSA each year, and you can contribute your own pre-tax dollars. The money in your HSA can be used to pay for your deductible and other qualified medical expenses, and it rolls over every year. It's a great way to save for future health care costs.

3.4 Prescription Drug Coverage

Both medical plans include comprehensive prescription drug coverage through [Pharmacy Benefit Manager Name]. Coverage is structured in tiers, with generic drugs having the lowest co-pay. Using the mail-order pharmacy service for maintenance medications can also provide significant cost savings.

3.5 Finding In-Network Providers

Using in-network providers saves you money. To find doctors, hospitals, and specialists in your plan's network, visit the [National Insurance Carrier Name] website and use their provider search tool.

3.6 Case Example: Choosing the Right Medical Plan

- **Scenario:** Alex is single, healthy, and rarely visits the doctor outside of his annual check-up. He wants to save for the future and keep his monthly costs low.
- **Analysis:** The HDHP is likely the better choice for Alex. His monthly premiums will be lower. Since he doesn't expect many medical expenses, he can save the company's generous HSA contribution and his own pre-tax contributions. The money will grow in his HSA and be available if he has a future medical need.
- **Scenario:** Ben has a family with two young children who have frequent doctor visits and a spouse with a chronic condition requiring regular specialist care and prescriptions.
- **Analysis:** The PPO plan may be a better fit for Ben's family. Although the monthly premiums are higher, the lower deductible and fixed co-pays for doctor visits and prescriptions will provide more predictable costs throughout the year, making budgeting for their high medical usage easier.

4.0 Dental Insurance

4.1 Dental Plan Overview

We offer a comprehensive PPO dental plan through [Dental Insurance Carrier Name]. The plan allows you the freedom to see any licensed dentist, but you will maximize your benefits and lower your out-of-pocket costs by visiting a dentist in the PPO network.

4.2 Coverage Tiers

The dental plan covers services at different levels:

Service Type	In-Network Coverage (after deductible)	Out-of-Network Coverage (after deductible)
Type 1: Preventive (cleanings, exams)	100%	100%
Type 2: Basic (fillings, extractions)	80%	60%
Type 3: Major (crowns, bridges, dentures)	50%	50%

The annual plan deductible is $50 per person / $150 per family. The annual plan maximum benefit is $2,000 per person.

4.3 Orthodontia Coverage

The dental plan includes coverage for orthodontia (braces) for both adults and children, with a lifetime maximum benefit of $2,000 per person.

5.0 Vision Insurance

5.1 Vision Plan Overview

Our vision plan, offered through [Vision Insurance Carrier Name], helps cover the cost of eye exams, glasses, and contact lenses.

5.2 Plan Allowances and Co-pays

Service	**In-Network Benefit**
Eye Exam	$10 co-pay, then covered in full
Prescription Glasses	
Lenses	$25 co-pay
Frames	$150 allowance, then 20% discount on balance
Contact Lenses	$150 allowance (in lieu of frames)

6.0 Mental and Behavioral Health Support

6.1 Our Philosophy on Mental Well-being

We believe that mental health is just as important as physical health. We are committed to providing robust, confidential, and accessible resources to support you and your family's emotional well-being. Asking for help is a sign of strength, and we encourage you to use these valuable programs.

6.2 Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

The EAP, provided through [EAP Provider Name], is a free, confidential counseling and referral service available to all employees and their household members, regardless of whether you are enrolled in our medical plans.

- **Services:** The EAP provides short-term counseling (up to **8 free sessions** per issue, per year) for a wide range of personal and work-related issues, including stress, anxiety, depression, grief, relationship problems, and substance use.
- **Other Resources:** The EAP also offers referrals and resources for financial planning, legal advice, childcare and eldercare services, and more.
- **Confidentiality:** Your use of the EAP is strictly confidential. The company does not receive any information about who uses the service or the nature of their concerns.

6.3 Mental Health Coverage Through Medical Plans

Both of our medical plans provide comprehensive coverage for mental and behavioral health services, including:

- Inpatient and outpatient therapy and counseling
- Visits with psychiatrists and psychologists
- Substance abuse treatment
  Co-pays and co-insurance for mental health services are the same as those for primary care medical services, ensuring parity.

6.4 Wellness and Mental Health Reimbursement Program

"What's the mental health reimbursement?" To further support your well-being journey, we offer a **Wellness Reimbursement Program**. The company will reimburse you up to **$500 per year** for expenses related to improving your physical and mental health. This is a taxable reimbursement.

- **Eligible Expenses:**
    - Gym memberships and fitness classes
    - Mental health and meditation apps (e.g., Calm, Headspace)
    - Weight loss programs
    - Smoking cessation programs
    - Wearable fitness trackers (e.g., Fitbit, Apple Watch)
- **How to Get Reimbursed:** Simply submit your receipts through the expense reimbursement portal under the "Wellness Reimbursement" category.

6.5 Case Example: Using the EAP for Confidential Support

- **Scenario:** David is feeling overwhelmed by work-related stress and is having trouble sleeping. He is hesitant to talk to his manager about it.
- **Action:**
    1. David remembers the EAP from this guide. He calls the confidential EAP hotline.
    2. The EAP counselor listens to his concerns and connects him with a licensed therapist near his home for a series of virtual counseling sessions.
    3. David uses his 8 free sessions to learn coping mechanisms for stress. The service is completely confidential and costs him nothing. His manager and HR are never informed of his use of the EAP.

7.0 Life and Disability Insurance

7.1 Basic Life and AD&D Insurance (Company-Paid)

The company provides Basic Life and Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D) insurance to all eligible employees at no cost to you. The coverage amount is **2 times your annual salary**, up to a maximum of $500,000.

7.2 Supplemental Life Insurance (Voluntary)

You may purchase additional life insurance for yourself, your spouse, and your children at competitive group rates.

- **Employee:** Up to 5 times your salary.
- **Spouse:** Up to $100,000.
- **Children:** $10,000 per child.

7.3 Short-Term Disability (STD) Insurance (Company-Paid)

If you are unable to work due to a non-work-related illness or injury, STD insurance provides income replacement. After a 7-day waiting period, the plan pays **60% of your weekly salary** for up to 25 weeks.

7.4 Long-Term Disability (LTD) Insurance (Company-Paid)

If your disability continues beyond the 26-week STD period, LTD insurance will provide continued income replacement. The plan pays **60% of your monthly salary** until you are able to return to work or reach retirement age.

8.0 Financial Wellness: Spending and Savings Accounts

8.1 Health Savings Account (HSA)

If you enroll in the HDHP medical plan, you are eligible for an HSA. This is a tax-advantaged savings account that you own.

- **Triple Tax Advantage:**
    1. Contributions are pre-tax.
    2. The money grows tax-free.
    3. Withdrawals for qualified medical expenses are tax-free.
- **Company Contribution:** The company will contribute **$1,000 for individual coverage** or **$2,000 for family coverage** to your HSA each year.
- **Ownership:** The funds are yours to keep and roll over year after year, even if you leave the company.

8.2 Flexible Spending Accounts (FSAs)

FSAs allow you to set aside pre-tax money to pay for eligible health care and dependent care expenses.

- **8.2.1 Health Care FSA (HCFSA):** You can contribute up to the annual IRS limit to pay for out-of-pocket medical, dental, and vision expenses. You cannot have an HCFSA if you have an HSA.
- **8.2.2 Dependent Care FSA (DCFSA):** You can contribute up to the annual IRS limit to pay for eligible daycare expenses for your children under 13 or for an adult dependent who is incapable of self-care.

8.3 Comparing the HSA and HCFSA

Feature	Health Savings Account (HSA)	Health Care FSA (HCFSA)
Eligibility	Must be enrolled in the HDHP	Available to employees not in the HDHP
Contribution	Employee and Company	Employee only
Roll Over	Yes, full balance rolls over	"Use it or lose it" (some carryover allowed)
Portability	Yes, you own the account	No, account is forfeited if you leave

10.0 The Claims and Appeals Process

10.1 How to File a Claim

- **In-Network:** When you visit an in-network provider, they will typically file the claim directly with the insurance company on your behalf.
- **Out-of-Network:** If you see an out-of-network provider, you may have to pay for the services upfront and submit a claim form to the insurance company for reimbursement. Claim forms are available on the carrier's website.

10.2 Understanding Your Explanation of Benefits (EOB)

After a claim is processed, you will receive an EOB from the insurance company. This is not a bill. It is a statement that explains what the provider charged, what the insurance plan paid, and what your financial responsibility (deductible, co-pay, co-insurance) is.

10.3 How to Appeal a Denied Claim

If a claim is denied, you have the right to appeal the decision. The first step is to contact the insurance carrier to understand the reason for the denial. If you disagree, you must follow the formal appeals process outlined in your plan documents, which typically involves submitting a written appeal with supporting documentation.

10.4 Case Example: Filing an Out-of-Network Claim

- **Scenario:** Ken visits a specialist who is not in his PPO network. The specialist's office requires him to pay the $500 visit fee at the time of service.
- **Action:**
    1. Ken pays the $500 and gets a detailed receipt.
    2. He downloads a claim form from the insurance carrier's website.
    3. He fills out the form and attaches the itemized receipt, then mails or uploads it to the carrier.
    4. A few weeks later, he receives an EOB and a reimbursement check. The EOB shows that the allowed amount for the service was $300. After his deductible, the plan paid 60% ($180). Ken is responsible for the remaining $120 plus the $200 balance billing amount that was over the allowed charge. His total out-of-pocket cost is $320.

11.0 Leaving the Company (COBRA)

11.1 Continuation of Coverage (COBRA)

If your employment with the company ends, or if you lose coverage due to a reduction in hours, you and your covered dependents may be eligible to continue your health coverage for a limited time under the Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA). You will be responsible for paying the full premium plus a small administrative fee. Information on COBRA will be mailed to you upon your separation from the company.

12.0 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: Is my spouse covered under the company health insurance?
A: Yes. Your legal spouse and registered domestic partner are eligible for coverage under our medical, dental, and vision plans. You will need to provide documentation to verify their eligibility.

Q2: What is the mental health reimbursement policy?
A: We offer a Wellness Reimbursement Program that provides up to $500 per year for eligible expenses, including mental health apps like Calm or Headspace. Additionally, our Employee Assistance Program (EAP) provides up to 8 free, confidential counseling sessions per issue, per year.

Q3: How do I find a doctor in my network?
A: You can find in-network providers by using the online provider directory on the insurance carrier's website. Using in-network providers will always result in lower out-of-pocket costs.

Q4: What is the difference between an HSA and an FSA?
A: An HSA is a savings account paired with a high-deductible health plan (HDHP), and the funds roll over each year and are yours to keep. An FSA is a spending account where you must use the funds within the plan year ("use it or lose it").

Q5: Can I enroll in benefits at any time?
A: No. You can only enroll as a new hire, during the annual Open Enrollment period, or if you experience a Qualifying Life Event (like marriage or the birth of a child).

Q6: Are my children covered after they turn 26?
A: Generally, no. Coverage for children ends on the last day of the month in which they turn 26, unless they are disabled and dependent on you for support.

Q7: How much does the company pay for life insurance?
A: The company provides Basic Life and AD&D insurance at no cost to you, with a coverage amount equal to two times your annual salary.

Q8: What happens if I get sick and cannot work?
A: The company provides Short-Term and Long-Term Disability insurance at no cost to you, which replaces a portion of your income if you are unable to work due to a non-work-related illness or injury.

13.0 Revision History

Version	Date of Revision	Summary of Changes	Approved By
1.0	Jan 1, 2024	Initial release of the comprehensive 2024 Health and Insurance Benefits Guide.	VP, Total Rewards